

Profile of a RAPIST

▶ HE HAS A DEEP PREJUDICE

Rapists harbour great anger for women and usually refer to them with disdain.

▶ HE BUILDS TRUST

Rapists prefer easy professions that give them access to the unsuspecting victim.

▶ HE PLANS METICULOUSLY

Rape is a well-considered act by the perpetrator and not an assault in the heat of the moment. The assailant uses charm in targeting the victim and then acts decisively at the first opportunity.

▶ HE HAS A TROUBLED PAST

Many rapists showed psychopathic traits with most of them having a difficult childhood characterised either by violence, bad parenting or repression.

▶ HE TARGETS THE VULNERABLE

Rapists often target the powerless such as adolescents and mentally retarded women. They usually intoxicate the victim or control them by extreme use of force.

me not to kill her. It disturbed me," he says. In every case, the trigger is power, not lust. As women's rights lawyer Flavia Agnes says, "It is difficult to decipher how the act of sex can be used as a weapon of humiliation and hatred."

The act is often now aided by the tools of modern technology which promise the illusion of fulfilment. The use of mobile phones to film and of the digital format to distribute have created a flourishing underground pornographic industry, which can be accessed at DVD libraries and in Internet cafes. The corruption starts from the formative years where children start to internalise gory projections of violence towards others, either through bloodbaths in the big screen or on ever slicker video games. "Screen exposure to violence leads to children becoming desensitised to inflicting pain on others," explains Nagpal. From there it can often be a short stop to becoming



RAPE OF A CLASS XII STUDENT Surat

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ACCUSED (From left) Sons of police officers, Tariq Saiyad and Shahid Saiyad, and mobile repair shop owner Abu Bakr Shaikh

DETAILS The trio have been charged with raping a Class XII student. Investigations reveal that they raped at least seven other girls and recorded the acts, which Shaikh then sold as porn.

CURRENT STATUS The three are in police remand. The police say that on the basis of their admission during interrogation and narco tests, they will be able to prove that they kidnapped the girl and her male co-student posing as policemen and raped her in turns in a moving car.

a rapist who derives sadistic pleasure in enforcing dominance over his victim.

Prashant Bhimani, a leading psychiatrist in Ahmedabad, can testify to 13-year-olds who watch porn on the Internet, compared to 10 years ago when this would be restricted to married couples or college youth. Says Bhimani: "On one hand, there is an urgent need for the Central Board of Film Certification to crack down on the excessive projection of sex on the screen while on the other, parents have to monitor what their children are watching at home." Neo-conservative groups in America have readily available data to support this. According to the National Coalition on Television Violence, one out of eight Hollywood movies depicts a rape; and by age 18, the average American will have seen 2,50,000 acts of violence and 40,000 attempted murders on television.

Add to that the increas-